



CONDUCTING RESULT AND IMPACT ASSESSMENT OF GENDER RESPONSIVE BUDGET IN BANGLADESH

**Final Report
on
Conducting Result and Impact
Assessment of Gender Responsive
Budget in Bangladesh**

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1. Background and Context

Gender Responsive Budgeting (GRB) is a strategic approach aimed at integrating gender perspectives into the budgetary process, ensuring that public resources are allocated in a manner that promotes gender equality and addresses the distinct needs of different genders. Since its inception in the mid-1980s, GRB has been adopted by numerous countries, albeit with varying degrees of implementation and success.

GRB is not about creating separate budgets for women but rather ensuring that budgetary decisions address the systemic disparities that women and marginalized groups face. This involves identifying how public spending and revenue collection impact individuals differently based on their gender roles, responsibilities, and access to resources. For instance, investment in childcare services has a profound impact on women's economic participation by alleviating the burden of unpaid care work—a responsibility disproportionately borne by women.

In Bangladesh, GRB has evolved significantly since its inception. The Ministry of Finance (MoF) began its gender budgeting initiatives in the fiscal year 2009-2010, embedding gender perspectives into national budgetary processes. This was an extension of the government's broader financial reforms under the Medium-Term Budget Framework (MTBF). The 2024-25 fiscal year marks a critical juncture, with 34.37% of the national budget and 5.23% of GDP earmarked for gender-related initiatives spanning 44 ministries. The new methodologies adopted in this period reflect the nation's commitment to aligning budgetary processes with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and its socio-economic priorities, particularly those addressing gender equity and women's empowerment. Despite notable progress, challenges persist in monitoring and evaluating the effectiveness of these allocations, necessitating innovative tools and frameworks to measure impact and ensure accountability.

2. Scope of Work

According to the ToR, the scope of work includes:

1. Consulting with the Finance Division and relevant organizations to identify 2-3 sectors/ministries to commission the impact assessment of sectoral gender budget in Bangladesh. Conduct necessary desk review of existing budget related reports and documents, policies, frameworks, and procedures used by the selected ministries.
2. Facilitating consultations/meetings with sectoral ministries to collate required data for the impact assessment.
3. Conducting in-depth consultations with key stakeholders, including ministry officials, gender experts, civil society organizations and think tanks.
4. Identifying international and national best practices, challenges, and areas for improvement regarding GRB implementation, and where gender responsive budgeting indicators can be integrated. Also, finding research gaps for further improvement of the fiscal policies.

5. Developing a mechanism including a set of indicators for guiding relevant ministries (i.e. Ministry of Finance, Ministry of Women and Children Affairs) in monitoring the gender budgeting process and progress of effective budget utilization.
6. Developing method for assessing the impacts of the Gender Budget in selected sectors/ministries
7. Organizing workshops and training sessions for government officials of FD and other relevant ministries to validate the identified actions to develop gender responsive budgeting framework and indicators.
8. Engaging with the concerned stakeholders and representatives from marginalized groups through dialogues and prepare policy notes for more gender-responsive fiscal planning

3. Study Methodology

The study will include a comprehensive desk review and secondary data analysis, followed by an impact assessment of GRB through quantitative exercise. Additionally, primary data will be collected through key informant interviews to understand the multidimensional aspects of the impact assessment of GRB and the GRB process itself.

3.1 Desk Review

The desk review stage will include the available national and international academic journals, books, reports and relevant grey literature. This stage will unveil the definition, justification, and country best practices along with the trend and pattern in GRB data. The literature review will include but not limited to:

1. Progress towards equality, Finance Division, Ministry of Finance, GoB
2. Klot, J., Economic, S., Holvoet, N., Villagomez, E., & Judd, K. (2002). Gender budget initiatives: strategies, concepts and experiences.
3. Budlender, D. (2002). Gender budgets make cents: understanding gender responsive budgets. Commonwealth Secretariat.
4. Budlender, D., & Hewitt, G. (2002). Gender budgets make more cents: country studies and good practice. Commonwealth Secretariat.
5. Downes, R., & Nicol, S. (2020). Designing and implementing gender budgeting—a path to action. OECD Journal on Budgeting, 20(2).

3.2 Qualitative Analysis (KIIs)

To address the qualitative aspects of the study, **6-8 Key Informant Interviews (KIIs)** will be conducted, with the final number and checklist confirmed after consultations with the client. KIIs are essential for gaining in-depth insights into the practical implementation and

challenges of GRB by collecting nuanced perspectives from stakeholders such as ministry officials, gender experts, and civil society representatives. A systematic approach will guide the process: gaps in existing information will be identified through desk research, and appropriate key informants will be located to address these gaps. Person-specific and comprehensive checklists will ensure that interviews are focused and relevant. The collected data will be systematically compiled, organized, and analyzed using qualitative data analysis software, such as NVivo, to extract meaningful patterns and insights. This approach will enrich the study's findings by providing a deeper understanding of the lived experiences and contextual factors influencing GRB processes, complementing the quantitative analysis.

3.3 Quantitative Analysis

The design of simulation: CGE modelling approach

The shock, rationale and expected outcome

To understand the impact of gender budget in education, data has been sourced from the Finance Division of Bangladesh. The simulation centres around the percentage change in government spending or national gender budget relative to the 2016-17 base year. For example, in 2016-17, the allocated budget for gender sensitive projects in Secondary and Higher Education Division was 8625 crore BDT which change to 7234 crore BDT in 2017-18, 9018 crore BDT in 2018-19 and 10827 crore BDT in 2019-20. So, the percentage change in gender budget with respect to 2016-17 was -16.13 in 2017-18, 4.56 in 2018-19 and 25.53 in 2019-20 respectively.

The CGE simulation model will analyze various trade-offs by examining changes in real incomes, consumption patterns, employment and other macroeconomic variables in response to the shock. A Social Accounting Matrix (SAM) prepared for the year 2016 serves as the consistent and comprehensive database for the abovementioned exercise.

Closure rules

In the CGE model simulation, specific closure rules were applied to control how the model balances and responds to change in gender budget. Closure rules essentially set assumptions about which variables are endogenous (determined by the model) and which are exogenous (fixed or controlled), helping to align the model's structure with real-world economic behaviour. Below are the closure rules we applied and the rationale behind each:

Numeraire (DPI is numeraire and fixed - CPI is flexible): By setting a consistent numeraire, we anchor the price system, enabling us to focus on real changes rather than nominal fluctuations. Given the shock's inflationary potential, this closure allows us to interpret how real incomes, production, and sectoral outputs respond to the shock rather than being obscured by arbitrary price movements. This is particularly relevant for Bangladesh, where

sudden increases in government spending could lead to inflationary pressures if not properly anchored.

Savings-Investment (investment is savings driven): In an ‘investment is savings-driven’ closure, investment depends on available savings, offering insights into how changes in gender budget spending affect long-term economic growth. For Bangladesh, changes in gender-focused spending in education and other sectors may enhance human capital and productivity but could also shift household savings patterns. If greater spending translates into improved incomes and savings, it can support higher investment levels and sustainable growth. This closure helps analyze whether gender budget allocations enhance economic potential or crowd out private savings and investment, balancing short-term benefits with long-term development goals.

Current Account (exchange rate is fixed, foreign savings are flexible): The change in national gender budget could lead to changing demand for imported goods as targeted spending boosts household consumption and sectoral investments. Allowing foreign savings to adjust while keeping the exchange rate fixed simulates how this increased demand affects Bangladesh’s trade balance and external stability. This closure is particularly relevant in assessing whether gender-focused spending pressures the current account by increasing imports or if it enhances export competitiveness through improved productivity and labor market participation. It provides insights into the external implications of scaling up gender-sensitive policies on trade and remittance flows.

Government Account (government savings are flexible, direct tax rate is fixed): This closure assumes that the government accommodates increased gender budget spending without immediately adjusting tax rates. For Bangladesh, where sudden fiscal adjustments are challenging, this approach reflects the likely response of financing increased gender-focused expenditures through budget deficits or borrowing. By using this rule, we can analyze how scaling up gender spending in sectors like education and health impacts fiscal balances and public debt. This allows us to assess whether such spending promotes long-term economic benefits that offset short-term fiscal pressures, providing insights into the sustainability of gender-focused policy initiatives.

Result

Education

Ministry of Primary and Mass Education:

In the Ministry of Primary and Mass Education, the gender budget allocation has seen a progressive increase in gender-focused expenditures over time. Table 1 shows that starting from a base year allocation of 10,938 crore BDT in 2016-17, the gender budget experienced fluctuations, with a marginal decline of 5% in 2017-18, followed by consistent growth in subsequent years. By 2023-24, the gender budget reached 19,841.8 crore BDT, representing an 81.4% increase from the base year.

Table 1: Gender Budget of Ministry of Primary and Mass Education

	2023- 24	2022- 23	2021- 22	2020- 21	2019- 20	2018- 19	2017- 18	2016- 17
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Gender Budget (in crore)	19841.8	17273.5	14943	14627	13881	12061	10393	10938
Percentage change from base year	81.40	57.90	36.60	33.70	26.90	10.30	-5.00	0.00

Source: Ministry of Finance

Gender-focused spending in education catalyzes labor market shifts, boosting productivity and skilled wages. The simulation results in Table 2 indicate that changes in gender budget allocation from the 2016-17 base year have had a significant impact on labor supply across different education levels and regions in Bangladesh. Overall, national labor supply shows a progressive increase with a peak change of 6.54% in 2022-23 which is driven primarily by greater participation of individuals who have completed primary education. Rural and urban labor trends mirror this, with urban areas experiencing slightly higher percentage changes particularly up to primary education level. Labor supply for individuals who have not finished primary education also increases even though to a lesser extent. It reflects the inclusive benefits of gender-focused policies.

Table 2: CGE Simulation Results for Primary and Mass Education

Total Factor Supply		Change From Base (%)						
	base	GB17-18	GB18-19	GB19-20	GB20-21	GB21-22	GB22-23	GB23-24
Labor - National	5.37	-0.10	0.24	0.70	0.92	5.68	6.54	3.01
Not finished primary	2.63	-0.07	0.18	0.56	0.75	7.74	8.56	2.76
Finished primary	1.00	-0.35	0.80	2.27	2.96	10.15	12.62	8.93
Finished secondary	1.08	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Finished tertiary	0.67	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Labor - Rural	3.20	-0.08	0.18	0.57	0.78	5.28	6.03	2.64
Not finished primary	1.84	-0.03	0.09	0.34	0.49	6.13	6.71	1.99
Finished primary	0.62	-0.30	0.68	1.95	2.57	9.15	11.29	7.79
Finished secondary	0.48	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Finished tertiary	0.26	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Labor - Urban	2.17	-0.14	0.31	0.89	1.13	6.27	7.30	3.56
Not finished primary	0.80	-0.16	0.37	1.08	1.35	11.46	12.82	4.55
Finished primary	0.38	-0.45	0.99	2.80	3.60	11.76	14.77	10.78
Finished secondary	0.59	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Finished tertiary	0.40	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00

Economy-wide wage	Initial	Change from base (%)						
	base	GB17-18	GB18-19	GB19-20	GB20-21	GB21-22	GB22-23	GB23-24
Labor - National	1.00	-0.37	0.79	2.11	2.63	3.91	5.75	6.98
Not finished primary	1.00	-0.06	0.12	0.29	0.32	0.49	0.75	0.85
Finished primary	1.00	-0.06	0.12	0.29	0.32	0.49	0.75	0.85
Finished secondary	1.00	-0.89	1.91	5.19	6.55	10.70	15.58	17.89
Finished tertiary	1.00	-1.25	2.66	7.19	9.07	13.19	19.78	24.24
Labor - Rural	1.00	-0.30	0.63	1.69	2.09	3.06	4.52	5.53
Not finished primary	1.00	-0.06	0.12	0.29	0.32	0.49	0.75	0.85
Finished primary	1.00	-0.06	0.12	0.29	0.32	0.49	0.75	0.85

Finished secondary	1.00	-1.02	2.18	5.93	7.53	11.57	17.05	20.29
Finished tertiary	1.00	-1.21	2.58	6.98	8.83	13.05	19.40	23.52
Labor - Urban	1.00	-0.48	1.02	2.74	3.41	5.16	7.54	9.09
Not finished primary	1.00	-0.06	0.12	0.29	0.32	0.49	0.75	0.85
Finished primary	1.00	-0.06	0.12	0.29	0.32	0.49	0.75	0.85
Finished secondary	1.00	-0.78	1.68	4.58	5.74	9.99	14.38	15.93
Finished tertiary	1.00	-1.27	2.71	7.33	9.23	13.28	20.03	24.72
Crop land	1.00	0.48	-1.00	-2.56	-2.57	-3.77	-6.47	-7.95
Capital - Total	1.00	0.02	-0.05	-0.13	-0.24	2.59	2.60	-0.34
Crops, forestry, fisheries	1.00	0.48	-0.98	-2.51	-2.48	-3.42	-6.07	-7.66
Livestock	1.00	0.73	-1.51	-3.92	-4.73	-3.39	-6.64	-11.80
Mining	1.00	0.13	-0.27	-0.76	-1.29	0.75	0.41	-2.45
Other non-agriculture	1.00	0.00	0.00	-0.01	-0.10	2.81	2.92	0.03

Source: Authors' simulation in the Bangladesh CGE model using GAMS (General Algebraic Modeling System)

Moreover, the simulation table shows the impact of changed gender budget allocations on economy-wide wages with significant gains for skilled labor and urban sectors. National labor wages rise steadily, peaking at a 6.98% increase in 2023-24 reflects an enhanced demand for higher-skilled labor. This reflects a positive chain effect, such as gender sensitive budgeting in primary level led to better participation in secondary level education for both male and female students. Agricultural wages (particularly for crop land and livestock) decline substantially, with crop land wages falling by 7.95% by 2023-24. These indicate a shift away from traditional agriculture toward urban and capital-intensive sectors. These results emphasize the gender budget's potential to boost productivity and skilled wages but point to the need for targeted policies to address disparities in low-skilled and agricultural sectors.

Directorate of Secondary and Higher Education

Table 3 highlights the substantial growth in gender budget allocations for the Directorate of Secondary and Higher Education from 2016-17 to 2023-24, reflecting a significant commitment to gender-sensitive education policies. Starting from a base allocation of 8,625 crore BDT in 2016-17, the budget initially declined by 16.13% in 2017-18 but rebounded in subsequent years, culminating in a 130.43% increase by 2023-24, with allocations reaching 19,874.9 crore BDT. The sharp rise in allocations after 2020-21 underscores a focused effort to enhance educational access and opportunities for women and girls at higher levels, aiming to improve gender equity and foster skill development. This upward trend demonstrates the potential of gender budgeting in secondary and higher education to address disparities, empower women, and contribute to long-term economic and social progress.

Table 3: Gender budget allocation of Directorate of Secondary and Higher Education

Description	2023-24	2022-23	2021-22	2020-21	2019-20	2018-19	2017-18	2016-17
Budget (in crore)	19874.9	15738.6	16124	12383	10827	9018	7234	8625
Percentage change from base year	130.43	82.48	86.94	43.57	25.53	4.56	-16.13	0.00

Source: Ministry of Finance

Table 4: CGE Simulation Results for Directorate of Secondary and Higher Education

Economy-wide wage	Initial	Change from base (%)						
	base	GB17-18	GB18-19	GB19-20	GB20-21	GB21-22	GB22-23	GB23-24
Labor - National	1.00	-1.17	0.34	2.00	3.47	8.28	7.92	11.82
Not finished primary	1.00	-0.19	0.05	0.28	0.42	0.98	0.99	1.31
Finished primary	1.00	-0.19	0.05	0.28	0.42	0.98	0.99	1.31
Finished secondary	1.00	-2.78	0.83	4.91	8.70	22.76	21.67	31.75
Finished tertiary	1.00	-3.92	1.16	6.81	11.99	29.39	27.92	42.28
Labor - Rural	1.00	-0.94	0.28	1.60	2.76	6.52	6.24	9.33
Not finished primary	1.00	-0.19	0.05	0.28	0.42	0.98	0.99	1.31
Finished primary	1.00	-0.19	0.05	0.28	0.42	0.98	0.99	1.31
Finished secondary	1.00	-3.19	0.95	5.61	9.97	25.19	23.91	35.74
Finished tertiary	1.00	-3.80	1.13	6.60	11.66	28.75	27.29	41.04
Labor - Urban	1.00	-1.51	0.45	2.60	4.51	10.84	10.37	15.45
Not finished primary	1.00	-0.19	0.05	0.28	0.42	0.98	0.99	1.31
Finished primary	1.00	-0.19	0.05	0.28	0.42	0.98	0.99	1.31
Finished secondary	1.00	-2.44	0.73	4.33	7.66	20.77	19.83	28.47
Finished tertiary	1.00	-4.00	1.19	6.94	12.21	29.81	28.33	43.09
Crop land	1.00	1.56	-0.44	-2.43	-3.55	-8.52	-8.77	-12.63
Capital - Total	1.00	0.08	-0.02	-0.12	-0.29	2.42	2.52	-0.48
Crops, forestry, fisheries	1.00	1.54	-0.44	-2.37	-3.43	-8.00	-8.26	-11.99
Livestock	1.00	2.36	-0.67	-3.72	-6.17	-10.54	-10.11	-18.60
Mining	1.00	0.41	-0.12	-0.72	-1.58	-1.01	-0.48	-4.36
Other non-agriculture	1.00	0.00	0.00	-0.01	-0.09	2.88	2.96	0.12

Source: Authors' simulation in the Bangladesh CGE model using GAMS (General Algebraic Modeling System)

CGE Simulation result of Directorate of Secondary and Higher Education reveals significant shifts across labor categories, education levels, and sectors. Table 4 shows that the national labor wages rise steadily, reaching an 11.82% increase in 2023-24, with the most substantial gains for tertiary (42.28%) and secondary-educated workers (31.75%). This underscores the role of gender-focused education in driving skill development and higher wages. Urban labor, particularly tertiary-educated workers, sees the highest growth (43.09%), reflecting the concentration of benefits in urban, skilled sectors. In contrast, wages for workers with no or primary education experience minimal growth (1.31% by 2023-24), indicating limited benefits for low-skilled labor. Agricultural wages, including crop land (-12.63%) and livestock (-18.60%), decline significantly which signals a structural shift away from traditional agriculture toward urban and capital-intensive sectors. These findings highlight the gender budget's effectiveness in enhancing productivity and skilled wages through education investment while emphasizing the need for policies to address disparities affecting low-skilled and agriculture-dependent workers.

Directorate of Technical and Vocational Education

The Directorate of Technical and Vocational Education has seen a steep rise in gender budget throughout the years. Table 5 shows that the budget allocation starting with a modest allocation of 229 crore BDT in 2016-17, the budget has grown exponentially, reaching 4,279 crore BDT in 2023-24 highlighting a 1,768.6% increase. This consistent upward trend, particularly the sharp increases in recent years (1,523.4% by 2022-23 and 1,032.8% by 2021-22), underscores a significant policy shift toward improving technical and vocational education for women. Such investments aim to enhance employability and participation in the labor force, especially in non-traditional sectors. The steep rise in allocations signals the government's commitment to bridging gender gaps in skill development and equipping women with the tools needed for economic empowerment and sustainable livelihoods.

Table 5: Gender budget allocation of Directorate of Technical and Vocational Education

Description	2023-24	2022-23	2021-22	2020-21	2019-20	2018-19	2017-18	2016-17
Budget (in crore)	4279	3717.7	2594	2317	2272	1980	1718	229
Percentage change from base year	1768.6	1523.4	1032.8	911.8	892.1	764.6	650.2	0.0

Source: Ministry of Finance

Table 6 : CGE Simulation Results for Directorate of Technical and Vocational Education

Economy-wide wage	Initial	Change from base (%)						
	base	GB17-18	GB18-19	GB19-20	GB20-21	GB21-22	GB22-23	GB23-24
Labor - National	1.00	48.67	42.41	9.15	8.96	6.47	1.79	-2.70
Not finished primary	1.00	6.35	11.00	3.38	3.60	3.33	1.11	-2.53
Finished primary	1.00	6.35	11.00	3.38	3.60	3.33	1.11	-2.53
Finished secondary	1.00	253.41	136.15	20.82	19.78	12.81	3.20	-3.30
Finished tertiary	1.00	314.86	166.40	24.87	23.45	14.52	3.31	-2.64
Labor - Rural	1.00	37.79	33.81	7.32	7.22	5.34	1.52	-2.46
Not finished primary	1.00	6.35	11.00	3.38	3.60	3.33	1.11	-2.53
Finished primary	1.00	6.35	11.00	3.38	3.60	3.33	1.11	-2.53
Finished secondary	1.00	272.54	144.27	21.09	19.87	12.36	3.03	-2.45
Finished tertiary	1.00	308.74	156.33	21.72	20.38	12.23	2.63	-1.90
Labor - Urban	1.00	64.63	55.03	11.85	11.51	8.14	2.19	-3.05
Not finished primary	1.00	6.35	11.00	3.38	3.60	3.33	1.11	-2.53
Finished primary	1.00	6.35	11.00	3.38	3.60	3.33	1.11	-2.53
Finished secondary	1.00	237.71	129.48	20.60	19.71	13.19	3.34	-4.00
Finished tertiary	1.00	318.81	172.95	26.93	25.44	16.01	3.75	-3.12
Crop land	1.00	-53.23	-55.76	-24.62	-26.80	-28.78	-13.52	75.34
Capital - Total	1.00	6.94	10.30	3.40	3.78	3.97	1.62	-6.57
Crops, forestry, fisheries	1.00	-37.70	-38.22	-17.90	-19.98	-23.51	-9.78	118.91
Livestock	1.00	-70.70	-73.70	-43.92	-44.45	-36.24	17.19	-6.55
Mining	1.00	-22.68	46.66	22.84	23.18	19.64	6.18	-15.62
Other non-agriculture	1.00	9.79	11.75	4.22	4.62	4.72	1.15	-6.83

Source: Authors' simulation in the Bangladesh CGE model using GAMS (General Algebraic Modeling System)

The impact of gendered budget is the highest for Directorate of Technical and Vocational Education. There has been a sharp increase in the national labor wage when the budget immediately rose by 650% in 2017-18. Agricultural wages, including crop land and livestock,

suffer substantial declines during most periods, but a recovery is observed in crop land wages (75.34%) under GB23-24, signaling structural shifts in resource allocation. Capital-intensive sectors, such as mining and non-agriculture, show mixed results, with mining experiencing early gains (46.66% in GB18-19) followed by declines. These findings emphasize the gender budget's effectiveness in boosting skilled labor wages and driving structural shifts toward urban and capital-intensive sectors, while highlighting the need for targeted interventions to address disparities in low-skilled labor and agriculture-dependent incomes.

The gendered budget allocations for the Ministry of Primary and Mass Education, the Secondary and Higher Education Division and the Directorate of Technical and Vocational Education demonstrate a transformative impact on the education and labor markets in Bangladesh. Investments in primary education enhance foundational education access, leading to improved participation in secondary education, as seen in SHED's allocations. This positive chain effect boost wages and labor supply for skilled workers, particularly in urban areas. Meanwhile, TVED's gender budget shows the sharpest increase in the national wage. However, the benefits are unevenly distributed, with low-skilled workers and agriculture-dependent sectors experiencing minimal gains or wage declines, reflecting a structural shift toward urban and capital-intensive sectors. These findings underline the importance of gender-sensitive budgeting in driving productivity, employability, and long-term economic growth while also emphasizing the need for targeted policies to ensure equitable benefits for low-skilled labor and rural communities. So, more gender sensitive budgeting is needed to provide benefits and training to low-skilled labour.

Environment and Climate

The Ministry of Environment Forest and Climate Change has experienced a gradual rise in gender budget in the initial years. There has been a fluctuation in between 2016-17 and 2023-24. However, it has shown an upward trend. Table 7 shows that the gender budget starting at 303 crores in 2016-17 saw a steady increase, reaching 956.8 crore in 2023-24, marking a 215.78% rise from the base year. The most significant growth occurred in 2022-23 (189.83%) and 2023-24 (215.78%), reflecting a stronger commitment to gender-responsive environmental policies. However, the budget dropped in 2021-22 (-9.27%), likely due to COVID-19-related reallocations.

Table 7: Gender budget allocation of Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Year	2016-17	2017-18	2018-19	2019-20	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24
Gender budget (in crore)	303	309	434	614	586	274.9	878.2	956.8
Percentage change from base year	0	1.98	43.23	102.64	93.40	-9.27	189.83	215.78

Source: Ministry of Finance

Table 8: CGE Simulation Results for Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Economy-wide wage	Initial	Change from base (%)						
	base	GB17-18	GB18-19	GB19-20	GB20-21	GB21-22	GB22-23	GB23-24
Labor - National	1.00	0.18	4.36	11.78	10.52	0.45	25.56	30.19
Not finished primary	1.00	0.04	0.87	2.12	1.91	-0.53	3.42	4.77
Finished primary	1.00	0.12	3.09	9.15	8.10	2.80	24.85	28.25
Finished secondary	1.00	0.38	9.22	25.54	22.72	0.96	60.09	70.31
Finished tertiary	1.00	0.52	12.47	33.74	30.08	0.22	76.91	89.62
Labor - Rural	1.00	0.15	3.58	9.63	8.61	0.40	20.82	24.56
Not finished primary	1.00	0.04	0.87	2.12	1.91	-0.53	3.42	4.77
Finished primary	1.00	0.12	2.99	8.88	7.88	2.70	24.17	27.47
Finished secondary	1.00	0.42	10.25	28.22	25.14	0.87	65.73	76.64
Finished tertiary	1.00	0.49	11.82	32.08	28.59	0.90	74.10	85.64
Labor - Urban	1.00	0.23	5.52	14.94	13.33	0.54	32.58	38.57
Not finished primary	1.00	0.04	0.87	2.12	1.91	-0.53	3.42	4.77
Finished primary	1.00	0.13	3.26	9.59	8.47	2.96	25.95	29.51
Finished secondary	1.00	0.34	8.38	23.34	20.73	1.04	55.45	65.12
Finished tertiary	1.00	0.54	12.89	34.83	31.06	-0.22	78.74	92.21
Crop land	1.00	-0.25	-5.48	-13.25	-11.46	2.97	-22.36	-28.72
Capital - Total	1.00	0.00	0.10	0.28	0.19	1.83	2.32	0.95
Crops, forestry, fisheries	1.00	-0.25	-5.47	-13.22	-11.40	3.20	-22.16	-28.66
Livestock	1.00	-0.35	-7.68	-18.49	-16.88	5.12	-29.77	-39.22
Mining	1.00	0.05	1.09	2.53	2.21	-2.79	-0.12	4.46
Other non-agriculture	1.00	0.01	0.30	0.75	0.62	1.85	3.28	2.00

Source: Authors' simulation in the Bangladesh CGE model using GAMS (General Algebraic Modeling System)

Table 8 indicates that there is a significant impact of gender budget interventions by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change. Overall wages have risen steadily, with the highest increases in 2022-23 (25.56%) and 2023-24 (30.19%), reflecting the growing impact of gender-focused spending. However, wage growth has been highly uneven across education levels, with tertiary-educated workers seeing the highest gains (89.62% in 2023-24), while workers without primary education experienced minimal wage increases (4.77%). This suggests that climate-focused gender budgeting is currently benefiting higher-skilled workers more than vulnerable, low-skilled laborers.

A significant gap exists between rural and urban wage growth, with urban workers, particularly those with secondary and tertiary education, experiencing faster wage increases. In 2023-24, urban tertiary-educated wages rose by 92.21%, compared to 85.64% in rural areas, reinforcing an urban-rural disparity. This indicates that gender budgeting has had a stronger impact in urban areas, likely due to greater access to education, formal employment, and economic opportunities.

Since, climate change disproportionately affects rural communities, particularly women engaged in agriculture, targeted climate adaptation programs must be integrated into gender budgeting. Women in rural farming, fisheries, and forestry face higher risks from floods, droughts, and salinity intrusion, yet the simulation results show declining investment in agricultural capital. By 2023-24, crop land value fell by 28.72% and livestock capital by 39.22%, indicating a shift in resources away from agriculture. If gender budgeting for climate resilience

does not specifically address the needs of rural women and low-skilled workers, economic and employment disparities may worsen.

4. International Best Practices

Gender-responsive budget (GRB) analysis examines how policies impact different groups of men and women as service consumers, infrastructure users, and taxpayers. It aims to create budgets that address gender-specific needs by integrating disaggregated data based on age, income, location, and education level. A thorough national budget analysis helps track progress toward global and local gender equality commitments and identifies gaps between policy goals and actual public spending. International agreements, such as those from the Fourth World Conference on Women, highlight the need for gender-focused budgeting to meet specific benchmarks and targets. Non-governmental organizations (NGOs) and international development agencies play a crucial role in promoting GRB adoption. UN Women has been instrumental in advancing gender-responsive budgeting by establishing global norms, fostering partnerships, strengthening government capacities, and generating research. Its work links GRB to broader agendas, including the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), aid effectiveness, public sector reform, and development financing (Stotsky, 2016).

Among the countries, Australia was the first to introduce and adopt GRB in 1984 even before the Fourth World Conference on Women (Sharp, 2016). Gradually, more countries adopted Gender-Responsive Budgeting (GRB), with Canada implementing it in 1993 and South Africa in 1995 (Sarraf, 2003). Bangladesh has integrated GRB by including it as an annex to the main budget documents and publishing it as a stand-alone report.

4.1 India

In 2004-05, the Ministry of Women and Child Development (MWCD) adopted the mission statement “Budgeting for Gender Equity” and developed a strategic framework to promote gender-responsive budgeting (GRB) (UNESCAP, 2018). Gender budgeting in India started in 2005-06. India’s Gender Responsive Budgeting process operates through two key components: Gender Budget Cells (GBCs) and the Gender Budget Statement (GBS). Currently, 57 ministries have established GBCs, while 35 demands for grants under 37 central ministries/departments are reported in the GBS, a significant increase from just 10 demands under nine ministries/departments in 2005-06. The GRB process in India remains largely confined to an ex-post analysis of expenditure statements published alongside the Union Budget (Mitra & Kutty, 2023).

The annual gender budget statements are categorized into three sections: (a) 100% provision towards women, (b) 30-99% allocations for women and girls and (c) schemes with allocations for women and girls below 30% of the provision. The initiative is lead by The Ministry of Women and Child Development with support from Ministry of Finance (India Budget, 2025). The percentage of budget allocated to gender sensitive programs in 2024-25 was 6.8%¹.

The government has introduced several key programs. Notable initiatives include Pradhan Mantri Awaas Yojana (PMAY) for housing, Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGS) for employment, Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0 for nutrition, Samagra Shiksha for education, and Samarthya (Mission Shakti) for women’s safety,

¹ [Gender Budget Statement 2024-2025](#)

Skill India Mission for skill development and economic independence of women etc (Ministry of Women and Child Development, India, 2024). These programs aim to improve the overall well-being and empowerment of women across various sectors.

4.2 Australia

The Commonwealth Government of Australia was a global pioneer in gender budgeting, introducing the concept in the 1980s. A key component of Australia's gender budgeting model was the Women's Budget Statement - served as the foundation for analyzing the impact of fiscal policies on gender equality (OECD, 2019). The country acknowledged the gendered impacts of mainstream spending and taxation. A key aspect of this approach is the recognition of unpaid care work within the economy (International Monetary Fund, 2021). In their 'Working for Women: A Strategy for Gender Equality framework', they outlined five priority areas for action: preventing gender-based violence, improving paid and unpaid care, ensuring economic equality and security, enhancing women's health, and increasing leadership and representation. The 2024-25 Women's Budget Statement and the 2023-24 Mid-Year Economic and Fiscal Outlook (MYEFO) track government investments and policy actions within these priorities. Initiatives like Paid Parental Leave reforms support shared caregiving responsibilities, which in turn reduce the retirement savings gap and promote economic security for women (The Commonwealth of Australia, 2024). The country has also taken steps to align with global gender commitments, notably through the two Australian National Action Plan on Women, Peace, and Security 2012–2018 and 2021-2031, which was one of the first initiative to implement UN Security Council Resolution 1325. This policy framework aims to enhance women's participation in peace processes and post-conflict reconstruction, ensuring their roles are recognized in national security and international diplomacy (Australian Government, 2021).

Gender equality became a key political priority during the May 2022 federal election. The government committed to making Australia a leader in gender equality by removing barriers to women's economic participation. It also aimed to close the gender pay gap and invest in social infrastructure to address gender-based violence and improve women's health and well-being (PM Hon Anthony Albanese, 2022). Moreover, all government sectors are responsible for ensuring that policies and decisions consider gender impacts, particularly in areas like women's safety and economic security. Starting from the 2023–24 Mid-Year Economic and Fiscal Outlook (MYEFO), all Cabinet Submissions and New Policy Proposals required a gender analysis (The Commonwealth of Australia, 2024).

Furthermore, Australia established the Gender Equality Fund in 2015 to enhance gender equality and women's empowerment in its aid program. The fund supports flagship initiatives in the Pacific and South-East Asia and promotes innovative investments at country, regional, and global levels through partnerships with the private sector and civil society. In 2020-21, the fund received an additional \$10 million to support gender-responsive COVID-19 efforts, bringing the total to \$65 million. The Australian Government has since maintained this funding level to ensure continued support (Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade, 2025).

4.3 European Union

The European Union (EU) has strongly integrated gender equality and gender mainstreaming into its political and legal frameworks. This has been reflected in the Gender Equality Index

2024 score where the EU score 71 out of total 100 points. The score reflects a 0.8 point rise from 2023 and a 7.9-point increase since 2010. Analysis shows that gender disparities across the EU narrowed between 2010 and 2022 with 15 Member States moving closer to the EU average despite differing starting points (European Institute for Gender Equality, 2025).

According to European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE), improving gender equality in the EU could increase GDP by 12% by 2050. Even top-performing countries may see a 4% GDP boost. Greater equality would enhance competitiveness, raise exports by 0.7%, and reduce imports by 1.2%, strengthening the trade balance (European Institute for Gender Equality, 2024).

Countries in the EU have exemplary gender budgeting practices over the years. Council of Europe (2009) highlighted some good practices-

- Sweden and Norway have strongly integrated gender mainstreaming and gender budgeting into organizational development. In Sweden, the Gender Mainstreaming Support Committee (JämStöd) created "The Ladder," a comprehensive framework of tools and methods that supports institutions in effectively implementing gender mainstreaming.
- Belgium introduced the Gender Mainstreaming Act in 2007, establishing a framework for system-wide gender budgeting. The law requires each government department to outline its spending on gender equality initiatives. These department-level gender notes must be included in the draft budget submitted to the Department of Finance and ultimately attached as a gender note to the Federal Budget.
- Spain's Organic Law 3/2007 promotes gender equality by establishing guidelines for integrating gender sensitivity and perspective into public contracting, as outlined in Articles 33 and 34.
- France's Law No. 2014-873 mandates local authorities to incorporate gender equality into all policies. Additionally, French companies may be ineligible for public procurement benefits if they fail to meet legal gender equality requirements.
- Gender equality is firmly embedded in Austrian law. Article 7 of the Federal Constitution mandates the Federal Government, Provinces, and local authorities to uphold equal treatment of women and men. Austria has implemented gender budget initiatives at the national, provincial, and local levels to support this commitment.

4.4 G-7

The G7 countries have strengthened gender equality by expanding parental leave for fathers, childcare support, and flexible work policies. Pay transparency tools promote wage equality, while equity targets enhance women's leadership representation. Improved financial access supports women entrepreneurs, and greater collaboration across sectors encourages young women in high-paying fields. Integrated policies also improve prevention and response to gender-based violence (OECD, 2023). Moreover, the G7 countries have introduced and implemented tax and expenditure policies to boost female workforce participation, including among low-income women. In these countries, the public sector is expected to lead by example and promote gender equality in employment (International Monetary Fund, 2017).

Some of the key gender budgeting initiatives taken by the G7 countries are:

Country	Gender-related initiatives
Canada	In Canada, gender equality is a joint responsibility of federal, provincial, and territorial governments with a proper coordination and engagement mechanism. Since 1995, the federal government has committed to gender-based analysis of legislation, policies, and programs, making it mandatory for all Cabinet proposals in 2015. In Budget 2017, Canada introduced its first Gender Statement, assessing budget measures through a gender lens.
France	France's 2014 Organic Law on Gender Equality made gender budgeting a key part of policymaking, requiring gender impact assessments for all new laws. It also introduced quotas for women in senior positions in the civil service, politics, and private sector. Since 2010, the annual Budget Law has included an annex on gender equality, outlining gender-disaggregated fiscal allocations. These measures ensure that public spending and policies actively promote gender equality.
Germany	The German federal government views gender equality as a core policy objective and has integrated it into budget-making. Since 2000, it has been a guiding principle in the Joint Rules of Procedure of the Federal Ministries. Implementation has been particularly strong at the subnational level in which Berlin being a leading example.
Italy	Italy has enacted gender equality laws at both local and national levels, with the national budget funding initiatives in maternal care, daycare, women's employment incentives, and combating domestic violence. A 2016 legislative decree on State budget reform introduced gender budgeting on a trial basis at the national level.
Japan	The Japanese government has promoted gender equality through legislative measures, including the Basic Act for Gender Equality of 1999. It recently formally adopted gender budgeting to integrate gender perspectives into fiscal policies. Key priorities include enhancing women's participation in policymaking and employment, improving work-life balance, and reducing poverty. The government also focuses on advancing women's education and health to foster long-term gender equity.
United Kingdom	The UK has integrated gender equality into fiscal policy through various initiatives. Key achievements include increasing women's participation in employment and entrepreneurship. Policies have also focused on creating a supportive environment for working mothers. These measures aim to promote economic opportunities and financial independence for women.
United States	In the U.S., recent legislation has aimed to combat violence against women and increase female representation in economic and technical leadership roles. However, the U.S. remains one of seven countries that has not ratified the UN Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW). At the subnational level, San Francisco's gender budgeting initiative focuses on prioritizing women's needs in public services and improving infrastructure, particularly for safe lighting.

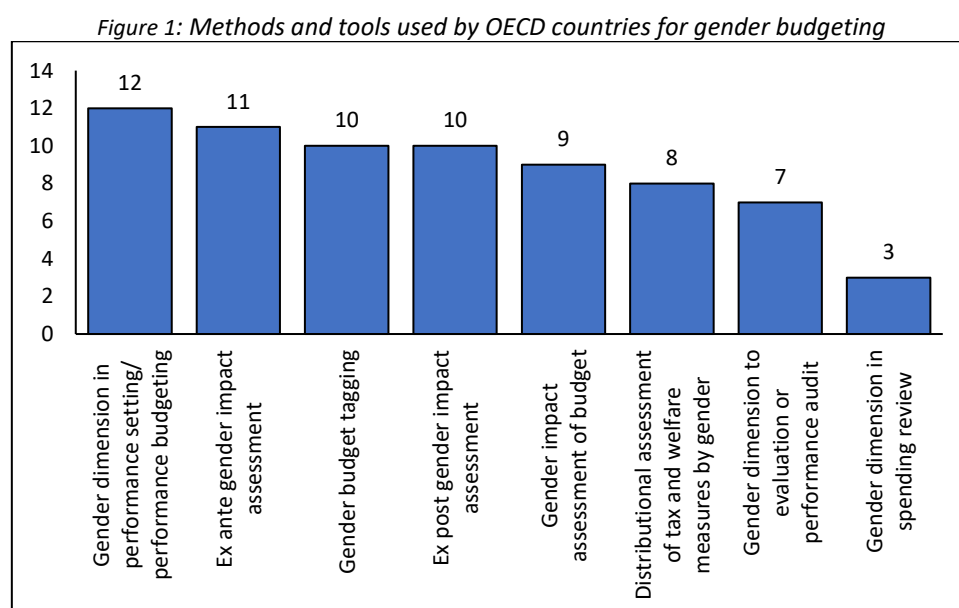
Source: Beijing Report, OECD, and IMF questionnaire

4.5 OECD

Gender budgeting is becoming more widespread in OECD countries, with 61% of member nations now using it to reduce gender gaps. The number of countries practicing gender

budgeting has nearly doubled, increasing from 12 in 2016 (35%) to 23 in 2022. This growth reflects a stronger commitment to integrating gender perspectives into fiscal policies. OECD countries continue to expand these efforts to achieve greater gender equality.

The Gender Budgeting report by OECD (2023) highlighted that as of 2022, there is no universal approach to gender budgeting across OECD countries. Instead, nations adopt methods and tools that align with their existing budgeting frameworks and policy environments. Countries with a performance budgeting system may integrate a gender perspective into their performance framework, while those with a strong tradition of gender impact assessment may require gender analysis for all new budget proposals. This flexible approach allows governments to leverage their institutional strengths while advancing gender equality in fiscal policies.

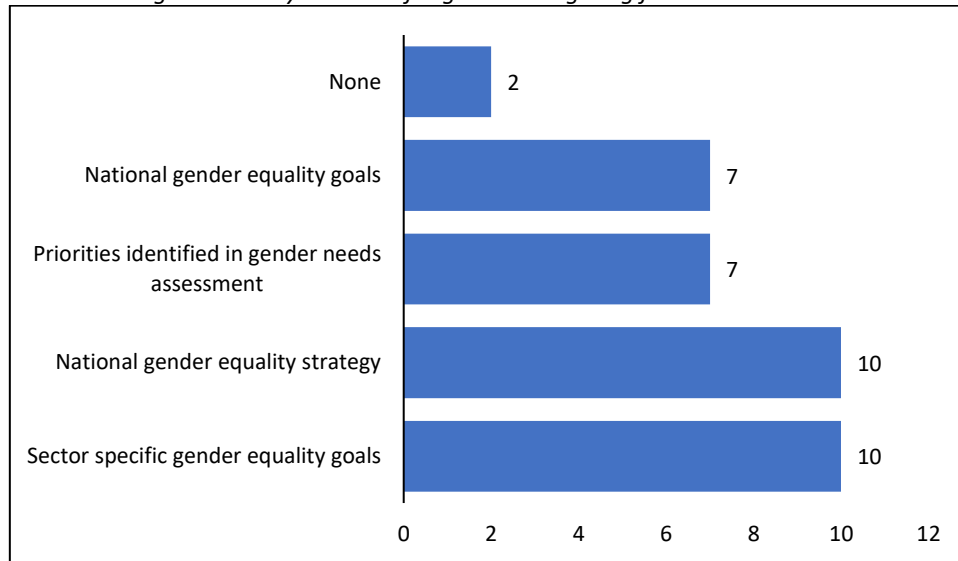


Source: 2022 OECD Survey on Gender Budgeting

In 2022, OECD countries used an average of three different methods or tools to implement gender budgeting (**Error! Reference source not found.**).

- Canada and Ireland applied the most tools (seven), making their approaches the most comprehensive.
- Other countries with a broad range of gender budgeting methods included:
- Iceland (six tools)
- Austria, France, Mexico, and Norway (five tools each)
- In contrast, Belgium, Colombia, Japan, Lithuania, and Türkiye each used only one tool

Figure 2: Policy direction for gender budgeting for OECD countries



Source: 2022 OECD Survey on Gender Budgeting

In 2022, 91% of OECD countries implemented gender budgeting had established strategic frameworks to guide their initiatives. Figure 2 shows that the most common approaches include sector-specific policies such as those in education and housing and national gender equality goals, both used in 43% of countries. Additionally, 30% of countries rely on gender needs assessments to shape their gender budgeting efforts. However, Australia and Italy are the only two countries practicing gender budgeting without a guiding policy framework. Austria has identified the lack of a national gender equality strategy as a key challenge, as it impacts government-wide cooperation in gender budgeting implementation.

4.6 Thailand

Gender-responsive budgeting (GRB) in Thailand has evolved via several substantial initiatives and policy frameworks aimed at promoting gender equality through fiscal policies. The following is a summary regarding Gender-responsive Budgeting in Thailand (OECD, 2020)-

- The Thai government has enacted legal measures to address gender disparities, notably the Protection of Victims of Domestic Violence Act and the Gender Equality Act. The 2017 Constitution forbids sex-based discrimination and advocates for equality between genders. The Budget Bureau now mandates that expenditure ministries specify the gender effect of their budget requests.
- The Thai government use gender budgeting instruments to incorporate gender issues into the budgeting process. The primary instruments are a gender budgeting manual created by the Department of Finance (DWF) in 2015 and gender budget stipulations for budget proposals. The manual seeks to implement gender budgeting in two agencies and evaluate methodologies throughout the government. It covers details on fundamental budgeting, procedural steps for execution, interesting facts, and implementation notes.
- Thailand's local government pilot programs in gender budgeting provide significant insights for national stakeholders, including the adaptation of local training modules for national implementation.
- The legal obligation for gender budgeting in Thailand creates a basis for strong governance frameworks. The nation should adopt a tiered approach, prioritizing institutional structures, integrating gender equality goals into national policies, and codifying gender budgeting specifics within the organic budget legislation. Thailand's Gender Budgeting Strategy:
 - Short term: Develop a comprehensive institutional framework for gender budgeting.
 - Medium-term: Align gender equality objectives within national policies.
 - Long-term: Establish gender budgeting details inside the organic budget law.

Gender Tagging of Budget Programs in Thailand

Develop gender tagging to report both gender-promoting and gender-mainstreaming budget programs.

- Utilize the budget bureau's data to identify and report on gender-specific allocations. Incorporate three gender-related options in budget proposal submission forms:
 - Primary objective: Budget plan prioritizing gender equality.
 - Indirect impact: The budget proposal has an indirect influence on gender equality.
 - Gender-neutral: The budget plan carries a neutral impact on gender equality.

Example- A program designed to support entrepreneurs to achieve 50% female ownership of businesses.

- Gender budgeting in Thailand commenced in 2006, initiated by workshops hosted by the Office of Women's Affairs and Family Development in collaboration with Friedrich Ebert Stiftung. The workshops seek to facilitate knowledge generation, evaluate the implementation of gender perspectives within the Thai context, formulate guidelines for

advancing gender budgeting, and establish a network of stakeholders engaged in this initiative.

- The Women's Development initiative within the Tenth National Economic and Social Development Plan (2007-2011) seeks to advance gender equality and enhance women's capabilities in Thailand. The initiative seeks to enhance human integrity, augment women's presence in politics and administration, elevate health policy involvement, mitigate violence against women, and promote economic participation. Five initiatives encompass engaging stakeholders to alter attitudes, enhancing women's involvement in political decision-making, augmenting healthcare accessibility, reinforcing women's human security rights, and promoting economic participation (Chakraborty & Singh, 2017; UNESCAP, 2017).
- Thailand emphasizes the importance of human rights obligations and the Sustainable Development Goals, emphasizing that the elimination of discrimination against women is crucial for socio-economic progress and sustainable development. The country utilizes the Universal Periodic Review (UPR) and CEDAW frameworks to promote gender equality and improve domestic legislation.
- Thailand prioritizes the dissemination of best practices, technical collaboration, and capacity enhancement, while ensuring equitable access to fundamental education for both genders. The nation prioritizes women's economic empowerment, with women comprising 60% of the workforce and 38% of management roles in the private sector (Permanent Mission of Thailand to the United Nations, 2017).

4.7 Cambodia

Cambodia is progressing with gender budgeting; however, it has not yet integrated this approach into a budget circular or legislation. Gender budgeting initiatives in Cambodia commenced recently as a component of a comprehensive public financial management reform program.

In September 2016, the government convened a national workshop on gender-responsive budgeting. A technical workshop on gender and financial issues was subsequently conducted with the Ministry of Economics and financial (MEF). A core group consisting of essential ministries and gender specialists was formed to cultivate expertise in gender budgeting. The government intends to execute gender budgeting via its budget circular, requesting gender budget statements and integrating gender-disaggregated data (Chakraborty & Singh, 2017; UNESCAP, 2017, 2024a).

During the 2017 Regional Forum on Gender-responsive Budgeting in Asia and the Pacific, the government reported its advancements, stating that it is currently in the phase of increasing awareness and building capacity regarding its gender budgeting objectives (Chakraborty & Singh, 2017; UNESCAP, 2017)

Since 2002, Cambodia has collaborated with international donors to promote gender budgeting. Significant milestones encompass:

- Development of MoWA Gender Budgeting (GB) guidelines to educate GMAGs from the Ministry of Economy and Finance (MEF), the Ministry of Planning (MoP), and ten-line ministries participating in a program budgeting pilot group (2014).

- A national gender workshop in 2016 focused on enhancing public investment in gender equality, facilitating discussions between the Ministry of Women's Affairs and the Ministry of Economy and Finance over the future of gender budgeting.
- A UNESCAP initiative aimed at institutionalizing gender budgeting inside the Ministry of Education, Youth, and Sports (MoEYS) throughout 2017–18.
- Workshops conducted by the IMF in 2021 and 2022 with representatives from MoWA, MEF, and relevant ministries to enhance gender budgeting capabilities.

In 2022, MoWA finalized a draft roadmap for gender budgeting, intending to amend it according to MEF feedback and establish explicit institutional coordination mechanisms for gender budgeting among MEF, MoWA, and line ministries (UNESCAP, 2024a)

Performance-informed budgeting is an essential element of Cambodia's Budget System Reform Strategy (2018–2025), and the formulation of Budget Strategy Plans (BSPs) functions as a means to evaluate program performance within the budget. This corresponds with gender-responsive budgeting, which incorporates gender concerns into program design and evaluation, utilizing performance measures to inform policy formulation and financing decisions.

In accordance with IMF guidelines, the Cambodian government acknowledges the necessity to enhance and elucidate the legal, institutional, and strategic framework for gender budgeting. The government intends to implement new instruments to facilitate gender budgeting and include these instruments into the budgetary process, in alignment with public financial management reform initiatives.

4.8 Sri Lanka

A handbook on Gender Mainstreaming and Gender Budgeting has been developed as a guidance for governmental agencies. In 2021, guidelines for anti-sexual harassment committees, referred to as 'Respectful Workplace Guidelines,' were established (UNESCAP, 2024b). Nevertheless, owing to the epidemic and economic crisis, these rules were not executed, and the committees became inactive. Prior to 2020, Gender Focal Points were designated by each Ministry, reporting to the Additional Secretary, with coordination overseen by the MWCASE. Nonetheless, difficulties continued in this modality and in the capacity of all Gender Focal Points to integrate gender considerations inside their respective Ministries.

The gender mainstreaming approach has enabled the incorporation of gender equality into various sectoral policies, such as the National Human Resource Policy, National Disaster Policy, National SME Policy, and TVET Policy. Gender mainstreaming is promoted by the Child and Women Development Units established at both District and Divisional levels under the MWCASE. These units are essential at the district and divisional levels by convening meetings of Child and Women Committees to tackle issues of gender-based violence, vulnerabilities, and relief initiatives. Capacity building on gender, in conjunction with consultations and the execution of national strategies on gender-based violence and Women, Peace, and Security (SCR 1325), is also facilitated through these units (UNESCAP, 2024b)

In 2002, the Ministry of Women's Affairs, in conjunction with UNIFEM, launched a GRB initiative based on the economic program 'The Regaining Sri Lanka,' associated with the Poverty Reduction Strategy (Chakrabarty, 2003). This was succeeded by a visit to South Africa in 2002 and the coordination of the Third Regional Workshop on GRB Analysis, together with a national workshop. Additionally, UNIFEM helped through Indian expertise and training on Gender Responsive Budgeting (GRB) in 2003, targeting policymakers and women's organizations (UNIFEM, 2005). A gender-analysis approach to budgets was implemented, drawing from an Indian model. This methodology classified expenditures into three categories: expenditures entirely for women, expenditures with a minimum of 30% allocated to pro-woman initiatives, and mainstream allocations with a minimum of 30% (Chakrabarty, 2003).

The analysis showed that only seven ministries implemented programs aimed at women, accounting for approximately 0.09% of overall spending. The Ministry of Women's Affairs constituted 0.02% of total governmental expenditure. Subsequent evaluations revealed constrained resources allocated across multiple initiatives, complicating the assessment of women's benefits (Chakrabarty, 2003). Diamond & Gajanayake (2004) indicated that the National Budget Statement mandated all ministries to designate 10% of their funds for the enhancement of women's status. Some researchers observed that general budget allocation segments encompassed social protection in women's development initiatives. Analysts noted that certain budget speeches specifically mentioned gender policies and programs (Budlender, 2007).

A 2007 evaluation revealed that the Ministries of Health, Education, Child Development and Women Empowerment, and Youth and Sports had advanced further in establishing gender-related targets and indicators (Budlender, 2007). The 2011 budget documents contained a section devoted to the 'Caring Society.' In the budget address, President Mahinda Rajapaksa (2010) reaffirmed the government's dedication to this industry. Women's organizations and civil society participated in the formulation of the National Development Framework, which guided the budgeting process and policy. Budlender (2007) observed that inadequate quality data constrains the government's ability to prioritize gender-responsive resource allocations and programs. Chakraborty (2003) underscored that budget research revealed a deficiency in transparency concerning gender budgeting data. This research encompassed not only the monitoring of variables related to health, education, and political engagement but also incorporated social and economic empowerment and poverty alleviation efforts at both provincial and district levels. Despite these efforts, none of the Ministries or the central planning unit of the government has established a dedicated cell or unit to analyze, assess, and advise on how to review their budgets through a gender lens (Herath, 2018).

4.9 Malaysia

Malaysia's Ministry of Women, Family and Community Development is implementing a gender-responsive budgeting program, supported by the United Nations Development Program. The brief about Gender-responsive Budgeting in Malaysia is given below-

- Malaysia already has a well-developed system of budgeting. The gender budget builds on this foundation and provides added value to the results-oriented approach.

- The EPU, MOF, and ICU are moving towards approaches that focus more on longer-term planning and budgeting, policy analysis, and assessment, rather than routine year-by-year financial monitoring
- The Malaysian government has much more control over its budget than many other countries that have tried to do gender budget work. For example, Malaysia has good control over the balance between revenue and expenditure. Also, donor countries have very little influence over the country's budget. This means that the government has a lot of freedom to decide where and how to use its resources
- On 22 April 2003, the EPU approved the project document for a gender budget pilot project in Malaysia led by the MWFC in partnership with the UNDP which would provide financial and technical assistance.
- Malaysia initiated gender budgeting initiatives via a pilot project including four ministries, concentrating on educational and training programs extending from basic education to university, inclusive of vocational training. The Malaysian government, the MWFC, and UNDP partnered to support these pilot ministries in their gender budgeting initiatives (UNDP, 2014).
- Penang, Malaysia, is the inaugural state to adopt Gender Responsive Budgeting (GRB) via the Penang Women's Development Corporation (PWDC). The initiative, subsequently rebranded as Gender Responsive and Participatory Budgeting (GRP), examines public expenditure choices for gender equality and enables citizens to directly impact budgetary decisions. Penang received a special mention award for its innovative approach (Kamruddin, 2018)
- Gender Budgeting in Malaysia needs analysis, clients, output specification, impact, and evaluation, it was proposed that the gender perspectives be incorporated within the existing program agreement proposal format (ABM-2) rather than produced as a separate format (UNDP, 2014).
- The 2022 Budget of Malaysia aims to integrate gender-responsive budgeting, encompassing female directors, women's youth leadership, and childcare facilities. Nevertheless, the budget exhibits shortcomings in tackling employment, safety, health, and social protection.
- Malaysia should design medium-term strategies for gender-responsive budgeting that match its vision and objectives for gender equality and women's advancement.
- A comprehensive approach is required, incorporating gender-budgeting evaluations and an intersectional analytical framework, which encompasses immediate actions such as gender budget statements and tagging, medium-term initiatives aligned with national gender equality objectives, and long-term assessments for evaluating the effectiveness of policies and programs (Fernandez, 2022).

5. Proposed Method for MoF to assess GB in the future

The proposed method will employ Expenditure Incidence Analysis to assess the distribution of public spending benefits across genders. This methodology is particularly valuable for identifying who benefits from government expenditures and evaluating how seemingly gender-neutral budgetary decisions may disproportionately impact women or men. By

analyzing data from selected sectors or ministries, the study will uncover patterns of allocation and usage that reveal gender disparities in public spending.

Gender-disaggregated expenditure incidence analysis (EIA) is a tool used to evaluate how well budgets and policies address gender equality. It assesses the distribution of public service spending across various social groups, focusing specifically on the allocation between genders (Austen et al., 2013). The expenditure incidence analysis examines how public spending is distributed between women, men, boys, and girls, considering their diverse characteristics. The analysis begins by calculating the unit cost of a specific service, then assesses how these services are utilized by different gender groups. Some other potential factors like age, race, ethnicity, religion, or rural/urban location, depending on the level of disaggregation can be added in this as well².

Shah (2005) showed three steps in estimating expenditure incidence. The key steps are:



1. **Defining the Analytical Framework and Income Measure:** The first step is to select the time period, analytical framework, and unit of analysis (e.g., household or individual). It's important to distinguish between direct effects (partial equilibrium) and indirect effects through price changes (general equilibrium). A counterfactual should be used that assumes government spending benefits are distributed neutrally, not one without government expenditure. It is to be noted that the most comprehensive income measure includes both private income and government spending (transfers, wages, purchases, and interest) minus taxes. Additionally, the decision of whether to conduct annual or lifetime incidence analysis to capture long-term benefits from investments has to be taken as well.
2. **Allocating Government Expenditures:** Government spending has to be allocated to specific family units, with the government cost used as a proxy for the value of benefits. Direct benefits like transfers or services (e.g., healthcare, education) can be easily allocated, while general expenditures (e.g., defense, law enforcement) are harder to assign. In some cases, disaggregating general expenditures, such as administrative costs of transfer programs can help identify specific beneficiaries.
3. **Applying Redistribution Indexes:** Redistribution effects have to be summarized using redistribution indexes. Local indexes (e.g., relative share adjustment) have to be used to measure redistribution within income groups, while global indexes (e.g., Gini coefficients) have to be applied to assess overall redistribution at the national level.

² [Tracking expenditures for gender equality | European Institute for Gender Equality](#)

From the above analysis, it can be inferred that, the following variables are needed to do the expenditure incidence calculation:

Step 1: Analytical Framework and Income Measure	• Time period (e.g., fiscal year, multi-year period) • Unit of analysis: - Household or individual level (e.g., per capita, per household) - Family size and structure (e.g., number of children/dependents) • Income measure: - Private income: wages, earnings, profits, rents, dividends, etc. - Government spending: transfers (e.g., cash transfers, subsidies), public wages, government purchases of goods and services, interest payments on public debt - Taxes paid: income tax, VAT, excise duties, social security contributions • Counterfactual assumption (e.g., benefits of government spending are allocated in a distributionally neutral manner, rather than a counterfactual that assumes no government expenditure).
Step 2: Allocating Government Expenditures	• Public expenditure data: - Specific expenditure (e.g., health services, educational subsidies, public transport) - General expenditures (e.g., defense, law and order, and administration) • Unit costs for services (e.g., cost per student, cost per patient) • Disaggregated general expenditure - Administrative costs of transfer programs to help identify specific beneficiaries. • List of specific beneficiaries
Step 3: Applying Redistribution Indexes	• Redistribution indexes: - Local redistribution index: Relative Share Adjustment (RSA) – redistribution within income groups (e.g., poor, middle class, wealthy) - Global redistribution index: Gini coefficient or other inequality measures to assess overall income redistribution 1. Income groupings: Income quintiles or deciles (e.g., poorest 20%, middle class, richest 20%) 2. Share of total expenditure by income group 3. Distributional effects: Share of government spending benefiting each income group or gender

6. Conclusion and policy recommendations

Gender Responsive Budgeting is an approach that aims to integrate gender perspectives into budgetary policies and processes, ensuring that resources are allocated equitably to address gender inequalities and promote women's empowerment. In Bangladesh, the implementation of GRB has gained momentum over the years, driven by both government initiatives and the advocacy of civil society organizations. Bangladesh has recognized the importance of addressing gender disparities and promoting women's rights as crucial elements of sustainable development while has made commendable progress in implementing gender-responsive budgeting, there is still work to be done. By addressing the remaining challenges and building on the existing achievements, Bangladesh can further advance its commitment to gender equality, women's empowerment, and inclusive development. There is some policy recommended that leads toward-

- The gender responsive budgeting process should be more streamlined. Expenditure Incidence Analysis should be conducted in order to ensure the effectiveness of government initiatives and budget plans. International best practices (gender audit, ex-ante, and ex-post gender impact assessment of policies, needs assessment, baseline analysis, gender dimension in resource allocation, etc.) should be introduced in Gender Budgeting.
- Proper initiative must be taken to gather more gender-relevant information and improve the quantity and quality of gender-related data and greater emphasis is needed on gender-segregated data. This is a prerequisite to developing a better evaluation of public policies. The Ministry of Finance should have a cell for the preparation as well as monitoring of gender budgeting- gender experts, researchers, and practitioners should be well-represented in the cell. A structured model should be established for a disaggregated database to ensure regular and quality gender statistics on government expenditure. Sex-disaggregated data should be incorporated into monitoring and evaluation frameworks to enable accurate assessment of gender-sensitive budgeting outcomes.
- Strengthening monitoring and evaluation of projects is crucial- in line with the broad objectives and benchmark of women empowerment. The implementation status of the programs should be monitored regularly. A comprehensive system should be created to monitor the use and impact of gender-related budget allocations across ministries and sectors.
- Gender assessment should consider the corresponding socio-cultural environment of the project implementation site. Gender analysis is also a part of the socio-economic analysis where they consider gender inequality in a specific context to build a better understanding of the different patterns of involvement, behaviors, and activities that women and men have in economic and social structures and the implication of these differences (European Institute for Gender Equality, 2022).
- It is important to strengthen coordination across ministries and local government to improve institutional capacity. Such coordination among ministries is necessary for ensuring coherence among different sectors of the economy.
- Training and development programs for budget and gender focal points across ministries are essential to enhance their skills in preparing sex-disaggregated data and implementing gender-responsive budgeting.
- Strengthening the capacity of the Ministry of Women and Children Affairs (MOWCA) as the lead ministry is important.
- Greater allocation from the budget should be made for gender-specific programs and projects. Gender sensitivity analysis of all development programs should be made mandatory. Necessary adjustments must be made before approval. Moreover, greater emphasis is needed on projects dealing with certain fundamental issues such as child marriage, domestic violence against a specific gender, education for girls, etc.

- Greater budgetary focus should be placed on addressing evolving issues (such as climate change) that disproportionately affect women, particularly in rural and vulnerable communities. Allocating higher budget to address these challenges is extremely crucial.
- Projects directly targeting the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) need to be prioritized while allocating the development budget. On that note, greater investment should be directed toward health, education, and social protection sectors to combat gender inequality and promote long-term gender equity.
- National and sectoral policies must be designed to be consistent with each other to facilitate development activities and enhance women's advancement and rights. Gender considerations should be integrated in fiscal and policy decisions at the local government level to ensure inclusive planning.

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Annex: Key Informant Interview (KII) Questionnaire (Education Sector)

- How does your organization conceptualize gender budgeting in the education sector? Does the sectoral ministry have any mechanism (structured/unstructured/semistructured) for measuring impact of gender budget? If not, what would be their suggestions to have such mechanism within the sectoral ministry?
- Can you describe the current gender budget allocation process for education in Bangladesh? What are the key strategies used to integrate gender perspectives into educational budget planning? How have gender budget initiatives evolved in the education sector over the past 5-10 years?
- How do gender budget initiatives address different educational levels (primary, secondary, tertiary)? Can you provide examples of specific interventions funded through gender-responsive budgeting?
- How have gender budget initiatives influenced girls' access to education? What changes have you observed in enrollment rates and retention of girls across different educational levels? Are there specific programs targeting marginalized or disadvantaged girl students? What investments have been made to create girl-friendly school environments? How are issues like menstrual hygiene, safety, and separate toilets addressed through budget allocations?
- How do gender budgets contribute to improving educational infrastructure and facilities? What capacity-building initiatives have been implemented for education administrators and teachers regarding gender-responsive approaches? How do gender budgets support professional development for female educators?
- What are the primary challenges in implementing gender-responsive budgeting in education? Are there any gaps between budget allocation and actual implementation? How do you measure the effectiveness of gender budget initiatives?
- What recommendations would you suggest to enhance gender budgeting in the education sector? What are the emerging priorities for gender budget interventions in education?
- Is there anything else you would like to share about gender budgeting in Bangladesh's education sector?

Key Informant Interview (KII) Questions: Climate Sector

- How does your organization define and conceptualize gender budgeting in the climate sector?
- Can you describe the current gender budget allocation process for climate change adaptation and mitigation in Bangladesh? What mechanisms are in place to ensure gender-responsive budgeting in climate policies and programs?
- What are the key strategies used to integrate gender perspectives into climate budget planning?
- How do gender budget allocations address the specific vulnerabilities of women and marginalized communities in the face of climate change? Can you provide examples of specific interventions funded through gender-responsive budgeting in climate action?
- How have gender budget initiatives influenced women's participation in climate resilience programs? What changes have been observed in women's access to climate adaptation resources and technologies?
- Are there specific programs targeting climate-vulnerable women, such as those in coastal areas, flood-prone regions, or drought-affected zones? How do gender budgets contribute to building climate-resilient infrastructure that benefits women and girls? How does gender-responsive budgeting address critical issues like access to clean water, sustainable energy, and disaster preparedness for women?
- What capacity-building initiatives have been implemented for policymakers, local governments, and communities regarding gender-inclusive climate action?
- What are the primary challenges in implementing gender-responsive budgeting in climate programs?
- Are there any gaps between budget allocation and actual implementation in gender-focused climate projects?
- How do you measure the effectiveness of gender budget initiatives in climate adaptation and mitigation?
- What are the emerging priorities for gender budget interventions in climate resilience and environmental sustainability?
- What recommendations would you suggest to enhance gender budgeting in climate policies and programs?



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